Celestial Voyagers

Stay Curious. Share Your Passion. Seize The World.

PENN STATE ABINGTON

TRAVELER'S BOOKLET

TOUR 2026



OCTOBER 25 TO NOVEMBER 1, 2026

YOUR ONLINE CONCIERGE PORTAL

https://yourtour.info/?tour=6493

Scan the code with your phone's camera, or type the full address into any browser. There is nothing to install and nothing to sign up for.

Travelers: the Traveler's Booklet as a flip book to read online, the Traveler Itinerary to download and keep on your phone for the days without a signal, and Memories, where you post photographs and reflections during the tour.

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6493 - Penn State Abington Trinidad & Tobago 2026

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CONTACT LIST

Type	Name	Phone	Notes
Celestial Voyagers	Gineth Cabello	(+1) 347-816-9104	Text or call

REQUIRED TRAVEL DOCUMENTS

- **Valid Passport:** Must be valid for at least 6 months beyond your arrival date and have at least one blank page for stamps.
- **Online Arrival and Departure Card:** Trinidad and Tobago replaced its paper immigration cards with a free online platform at travel.gov.tt. Each traveler must complete the arrival card before October 25 and the departure card before November 1. The form may be submitted up to 72 hours before each journey. Save or print the receipt with its QR codes to present to the immigration officer on arrival and on departure.
- **Return Ticket:** Proof of a confirmed return flight (your American Airlines e-ticket receipt).



A United States passport.

Online Arrival and Departure Card Checklist

Every traveler completes this free form at the official site **https://travel.gov.tt/en**.

- ☐ **Passport:** a valid passport, plus a copy of its photo (biodata) page saved as a JPEG or PNG file.
- ☐ **Email:** a valid email address.
- ☐ **Flights:** your flight information (flight numbers and dates).
- ☐ **Arrival card:** complete it within 72 hours before you land; it opens October 22 for the October 25 arrival.
- ☐ **Departure card:** complete it within 72 hours before you leave; it opens October 29 for the November 1 departure.
- ☐ **Receipts:** save each receipt with its QR codes. Print it or download it to your phone, and show it to Immigration and Customs officers.



Sample return ticket receipt. Yours shows your own name and booking reference.

AIRLINE NOTES

Make sure to check in at the airport 3 hours prior to departure. Complete online check-in in advance whenever possible.

Baggage allowance

Baggage Type	Maximum Dimensions	Allowance and Fee Details
Carry-on	22 x 14 x 9 in (56 x 36 x 23 cm)	No published weight limit on flights from the USA to Trinidad and Tobago. Must fit in the overhead bin.
Personal item	18 x 14 x 8 in (45 x 35 x 20 cm)	Such as a purse or small backpack; must fit under the seat in front of you.
Checked bag	62 in / 158 cm total (length + width + height) Maximum weight 50 lbs / 23 kg	No complimentary checked bag is included in the group fare. $50.00 each way at the airport, $45.00 if prepaid online at aa.com; paid to the airline.

The group fare is booked with no complimentary checked bag (0 pieces per passenger on the booking record). Checked-bag fees are paid directly to American Airlines, online or at check-in.

FLIGHT DETAILS

American Airlines

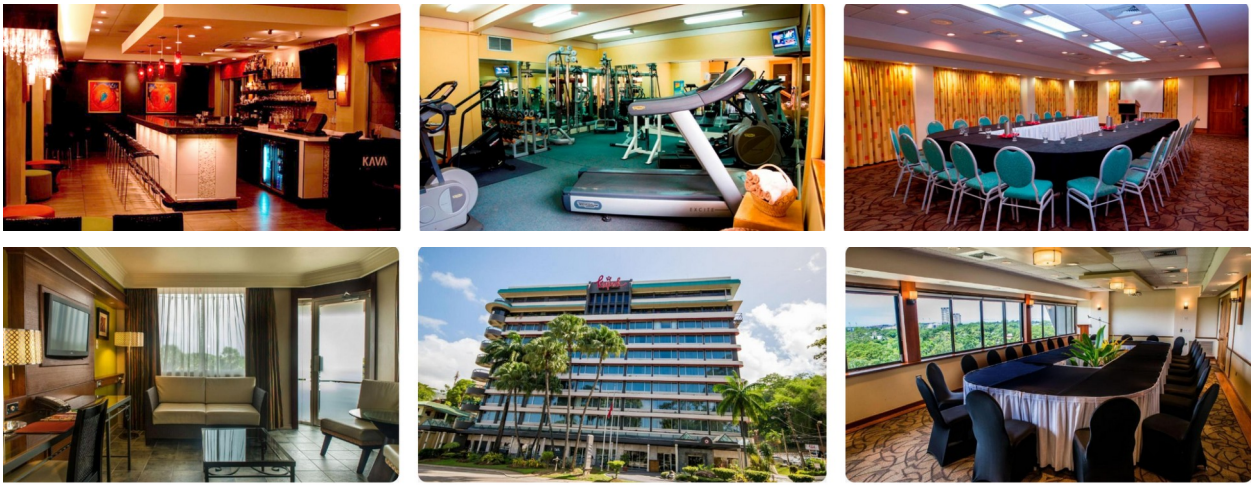
Day	Date	From	Departs	Flight	To	Arrives (local)
Sunday	October 25, 2026	Philadelphia (PHL)	6:00 am	**AA 1252**	Miami (MIA)	8:59 am
Sunday	October 25, 2026	Miami (MIA)	10:11 am	**AA 2703**	Port of Spain (POS)	2:08 pm
Sunday	November 1, 2026	Port of Spain (POS)	4:42 pm	**AA 799**	Miami (MIA)	7:59 pm
Sunday	November 1, 2026	Miami (MIA)	9:45 pm	**AA 2236**	Philadelphia (PHL)	12:38 am (Nov 2)

Flight services

Flight	Route	Duration	Class	Aircraft	On board
AA 1252	PHL to MIA	2 hr 59 min, nonstop	Economy (N)	Boeing 737 MAX 8	Refreshments
AA 2703	MIA to POS	3 hr 57 min, nonstop	Economy (N)	Boeing 737-800	Food for purchase
AA 799	POS to MIA	4 hr 17 min, nonstop	Economy (O)	Boeing 737-800	Food for purchase
AA 2236	MIA to PHL	2 hr 53 min, nonstop	Economy (O)	Boeing 737 MAX 8	Refreshments

HOTEL DETAILS

Kapok Hotel (Port of Spain, Trinidad)	
Kapok Hotel is a locally owned boutique hotel of 94 rooms and suites in the quiet St. Clair neighborhood of Port of Spain, within walking distance of Queen's Park Savannah, the Magnificent Seven mansions, the Royal Botanic Gardens and the Emperor Valley Zoo. Every room has complimentary high-speed Wi-Fi, air conditioning and a flat-screen TV, and many look out over the Northern Range or the Savannah. The hotel has a pool set in tropical greenery and two restaurants: Tiki Village, the treetop restaurant on the top floor where breakfast is served, and KAVA, with brick-oven pizzas, burgers and pastas.	
Address: 16-18 Cotton Hill Road, St. Clair, Port of Spain, Trinidad, W.I. **Phone:** (868) 622-5765	**Check-in:** October 25, 2026 **Check-out:** October 27, 2026 **2 nights**



Kapok Hotel, Port of Spain: KAVA bar, fitness room, meeting rooms, a suite and the hotel exterior.

HOTEL DETAILS (continued)

Starfish Tobago Resort (Courland Bay, Tobago)	
This oceanfront resort of 125 rooms sits on Courland Bay along Tobago's western coast, about five miles from Scarborough and under nine miles from ANR Robinson International Airport. It offers buffet-style dining, poolside bars and recreation options that include snorkeling, kayaking, scuba diving and deep-sea fishing, and bike rentals for exploring the property and its tropical gardens. Guest rooms are styled in light colors with a small seating area, private balcony, TV and safety deposit box. The Courlanders restaurant serves buffet breakfast, lunch and dinner overlooking the beach; D'Bay Grill offers sandwiches and grill items; and the Kiskadee Restaurant opens seasonally for buffet or a la carte dinner.	
Address: Courland Bay, Scarborough, Tobago, W.I. **Phone:** (868) 639-2851	**Check-in:** October 27, 2026 **Check-out:** November 1, 2026 **5 nights**



Starfish Tobago Resort, Courland Bay: the beach, the lobby, the pool and a guest room.

ROOMING LIST

Twin rooms (2 separate beds)

1	Liya Aji	Jonellis Heredia
2	Keira-Simone Rose	Simone Salguero
3	Kayli Nunez	Juliana Cardenas
	Total twin rooms	**3**

Single rooms

1	Katrina Black Reed	
2	Kimberley Hemmings-Jarrett	
3	Hussein Shamaa	
4	Brooke Breyterman	
	Total single rooms	**4**

Total rooms: 3 twin and 4 single, 10 travelers.

JOURNEY OVERVIEW

Date	Overnight City	Meals Included
Sunday, October 25, 2026	Port of Spain, Trinidad	
Monday, October 26, 2026	Port of Spain, Trinidad	Breakfast, Lunch
Tuesday, October 27, 2026	Courland Bay, Tobago	Breakfast
Wednesday, October 28, 2026	Courland Bay, Tobago	Breakfast
Thursday, October 29, 2026	Courland Bay, Tobago	Breakfast, Lunch
Friday, October 30, 2026	Courland Bay, Tobago	Breakfast
Saturday, October 31, 2026	Courland Bay, Tobago	Breakfast
Sunday, November 1, 2026	Return to Philadelphia	Breakfast

Meals: B = Breakfast, L = Lunch. Lunch on Day 2 is the traditional Moruga meal; lunch on Day 5 is the light lunch at Shore Things.



Parlatuvier Bay on Tobago's Caribbean coast, on the Day 4 route to the Main Ridge Forest Reserve.

DAILY ITINERARY

Day 1 | Sunday, October 25, 2026 - Departure to Trinidad

Depart with American Airlines from Philadelphia (AA 1252 at 6:00 am) via Miami (AA 2703 at 10:11 am), arriving in Port of Spain, Trinidad (POS) at 2:08 pm.

2:08 pm: Upon arrival in Trinidad, meet your airport representative, who will welcome the group and take you to your private coach to experience the wetlands.

CARONI SWAMP NATURE TOUR **Duration: 4:00 pm to 7:00 pm**

Immerse yourself in the remarkable natural splendor of Trinidad's renowned Caroni Wetlands. Traverse peaceful lagoons and natural waterways aboard a flat-bottom vessel, affording panoramic views of the captivating landscape.

Highlights include:

- **Scenic Boat Excursion:** Enjoy a tranquil voyage through an intricate web of channels lined with thriving mangrove vegetation.
- **Wildlife Observation:** Observe native fauna including vibrant bird species, caimans and reptiles, with guidance on the local ecosystem.
- **Scarlet Ibis Roosting:** Experience the breathtaking dusk spectacle as hundreds of brilliant scarlet birds gather in the trees.
- **Sunset Return:** Complete the journey with a serene cruise back during sunset.

Overnight: Kapok Hotel, Port of Spain, Trinidad



Scarlet ibis, the national bird of Trinidad, seen at the Caroni Swamp on Day 1.

Day 2 | Monday, October 26, 2026 - Trinidad (B, L)

Enjoy breakfast at your hotel and get ready for a full guided day.

MORUGA HERITAGE TOUR **Duration: 9:00 am to 5:00 pm**

Local tradition and monuments state that Christopher Columbus landed in Moruga during his third voyage in 1498.

Discover the rich history and vibrant living heritage of Moruga with this full-day immersive tour, designed to offer a deep connection to one of Trinidad's most culturally significant regions. The experience highlights African-American settlement history, oral traditions, religious heritage and community life, complemented by local cuisine and coastal recreation.

Highlights include:

- **Merikin Communities:** Visit settlements established by African-American soldiers in the 19th century. Gain insight into their migration, land grants, cultural practices and enduring contributions to Trinidad and Tobago's social history.
- **Folklore and Oral Tradition:** Engage in guided storytelling to learn about revered figures like Papa Neeza. Visit the home and chapel ruins of Mother Corn Husk, a significant spiritual and cultural landmark tied to Moruga's oral history.
- **Historic Moruga Spring Bridge:** Learn about the engineering and historical significance of this structure within the context of the area's development.
- **St. Vincent Ferrer Roman Catholic Church:** View this iconic architectural and religious landmark, central to the community.
- **Coastal Relaxation:** Enjoy sea bathing at the Grand Chemin Beach Facility, appreciating Moruga's natural coastal environment.
- **Traditional Culinary Experience:** Conclude the tour with a traditional lunch featuring Moruga's distinctive hill rice, engaging with local culinary heritage and community hospitality.

Overnight: Kapok Hotel, Port of Spain, Trinidad



Moruga's distinctive hill rice, served at the Day 2 traditional lunch.

Day 3 | Tuesday, October 27, 2026 - Trinidad to Tobago (B)

Enjoy breakfast at your hotel and check out.

STEELPAN FACTORY TOUR: THE MAKING OF THE STEELPAN **Duration: 9:30 am to 12:30 pm (approximate)**

This Steelpan Factory Tour offers an engaging and educational experience, guiding visitors through the intricate process behind the creation of Trinidad and Tobago's national instrument. Participants will observe the meticulous, step-by-step transformation of a steel drum into a finely crafted steelpan, and explore the instrument's historical context and evolution.

The tour offers direct interaction with skilled artisans, with opportunities to ask questions and gain in-depth insight into the manufacturing process.

The experience culminates in a guided, hands-on session, allowing visitors to play the steelpan and bridge the journey from creation to performance.

After the tour, the group heads straight to the port for the ferry transfer to Tobago.

4:00 pm: Afternoon ferry from Port of Spain to Scarborough, Tobago.

6:00 pm: Arrival in Tobago and transfer to the resort.

Overnight: Starfish Tobago Resort, Courland Bay, Tobago



The Port of Spain ferry terminal, where the Day 3 ferry to Tobago departs.

Day 4 | Wednesday, October 28, 2026 - Tobago (B)

Enjoy breakfast at your resort.

TOBAGO RAINFOREST TOUR **Duration: 9:00 am to 2:00 pm (approximate)**

Our tour follows the picturesque Caribbean coast, where we take in beautiful coastal and forest scenery as we visit small villages and towns.

Our moderate hike takes us into the Main Ridge Forest Reserve, which stretches for about two-thirds of the island. It is the oldest protected rainforest reserve in the Western Hemisphere.

You will walk along the Gilpin Trail, the island's oldest named and best-marked trail. The terrain is mostly flat and easy to navigate, and we will walk at a relaxed pace. Many bird species live here, while manicou and crabs patrol the undergrowth. Hanging bats and burrowing armadillos also call Tobago home. Despite its small size, the island is a key destination for unique biodiversity.

The plants are just as spectacular, from massive bamboo groves to spiny palms and bright red scarlet heliconia blooms. Your guide will point out the natural healing properties of many plants and share other interesting facts.

Breathe in the fresh, pure air and feel yourself become one with nature.

Overnight: Starfish Tobago Resort, Courland Bay, Tobago



Gilpin Trace in the Main Ridge Forest Reserve, Tobago: the Day 4 rainforest walk.

Day 5 | Thursday, October 29, 2026 - Tobago (B, L)

Enjoy breakfast at your resort.

CHOCOLATE MAKING EXPERIENCE AND TOBAGO HIGHLIGHTS TOUR **Duration: 9:00 am to 3:00 pm**

Kick off your morning with an interactive workshop at Shore Things, tracing the captivating path from cacao bean to finished confectionery while crafting custom delights.

Relish an included light lunch highlighting regional culinary traditions prior to embarking on a guided exploration of Scarborough.

Gain captivating insights into the island heritage and local lore of Tobago's capital city. Pause at historic Fort King George to behold stunning ocean views spanning the Atlantic expanse.

Journey through scenic coastal hamlets as you cross over to the Caribbean shoreline. Stop by Plymouth's Fort James to contemplate the enigmatic 1783 epitaph carved into the tombstone of Betty Stiven, complemented by sweeping vistas of Courland Bay.

Conclude your scenic return drive with a stop at vibrant Store Bay, where you can unwind beneath the shade, stroll along the sandy shore, or browse colorful stalls brimming with handcrafted souvenirs and local crafts.

Overnight: Starfish Tobago Resort, Courland Bay, Tobago



Cacao pods on the tree, the source of the chocolate made at Shore Things on Day 5.

Day 6 | Friday, October 30, 2026 - Tobago (B)

Enjoy breakfast at your resort.

GLASS BOTTOM BOAT TOUR AND PIGEON POINT BEACH STOP **Duration: 10:00 am to 4:00 pm**

After your hotel pick-up and transfer to the beach, board a covered glass-bottom boat and ride out to magnificent Buccoo Reef. Enjoy the fresh breeze and take in sweeping panoramas of the tropical coast. Take in the astounding views of the coral-covered ocean floor through the glass bottom of the boat while watching exotic fish.

You can join them as you snorkel alongside these colorful creatures on the next stop. Snorkeling gear is provided; however, you may bring your own snorkel mask. The next stop is the famous Nylon Pool, a sandy area in the middle of the ocean that is only 3.2 feet (1 m) deep.

Go for a swim in the warm, crystal-clear water. The water is absolutely calm; float on top of the soft turquoise water and relax, a Caribbean dream!

After your delightful boat adventure, spend some relaxing time on the beach at Pigeon Point and have lunch (on your own).

Note: The sequence of tour elements may change according to weather or other circumstances.

Overnight: Starfish Tobago Resort, Courland Bay, Tobago



The jetty at Pigeon Point, Tobago, the Day 6 beach stop.

Day 7 | Saturday, October 31, 2026 - Tobago (B)

Enjoy breakfast at your resort, then participate in the vibrant cultural festivities of the Tobago Carnival.

Complimentary activities include:

- **Beach Liming at Store Bay:** Located right in Crown Point, the Store Bay Beach Facility is free to enter and bustling with carnival visitors. It is a fantastic spot to grab local street foods like crab and dumplings while listening to the local music trucks passing through the area.
- **Scarborough Esplanade Stroll:** Walk down Milford Road in the afternoon. You can check out local craft vendors setting up their stalls early and enjoy the coastal views before the streets close for the evening parades.

CARNIVAL CELEBRATIONS **Duration: Throughout the day | Tobago**

Morning: J'ouvert, the traditional opening of carnival, fills the streets with music, paint and powder as revelers dance through town.

Afternoon and evening: Music trucks, steelbands and costumed bands bring color and rhythm to the streets, with celebrations continuing into the night.

- **Viewing:** Your tour leader will share the day's confirmed times and the best places to watch the celebrations.
- **Getting Around:** Roads close for the processions, so allow extra time and travel with your group.
- **Staying Together:** Agree on a meeting point and time before the celebrations begin, and keep your phone charged.
- **Attire Note:** Wear light clothing you do not mind getting covered in paint or powder; this is a high-energy street celebration.

ONE JAMMIN STREET PARTY **Duration: 8:00 pm to 12:00 am | Canaan/Bon Accord**

Free. Organized by the Crown Point Art and Street Festival Committee, this gathering highlights district culture through street processions, live musical acts and night celebrations.

Optional paid event:

SAND JAM TOBAGO **Duration: 10:00 am to 4:00 pm | Pigeon Point Beach**

An energetic beach party on the day of J'ouvert. Tickets start at TT$200 (Trinidad and Tobago dollars, about US$30 per guest) and are sold online at islandetickets.com/event/sandjam2026. Bring photo identification. Private taxi transportation can be coordinated directly through the resort reception.

Overnight: Starfish Tobago Resort, Courland Bay, Tobago



Day 8 | Sunday, November 1, 2026 - Return to Philadelphia (B)

Enjoy an early breakfast, check out of the resort and transfer to the ferry terminal in Scarborough.

6:30 am: Hotel pick-up for the ferry terminal.

9:30 am: Morning ferry from Scarborough, Tobago, to Port of Spain, Trinidad. Arrival in Port of Spain at approximately 12:30 pm.

1:45 pm: Approximate arrival at Piarco International Airport by private transfer from the ferry terminal. Lunch on your own at the airport. Please complete online check-in in advance.

4:42 pm: American Airlines AA 799 departs Port of Spain, arriving in Miami at 7:59 pm.

9:45 pm: American Airlines AA 2236 departs Miami, arriving in Philadelphia at 12:38 am on Monday, November 2, 2026.

Welcome back home! We hope your journey was truly wonderful and memorable.



An American Airlines jet; the group flies home with American on Day 8.

GENERAL INFORMATION ABOUT GROUP TIPPING

- Tipping is originally a way of saying "thank you", showing that you were happy with the services you received.
- Tipping is a personal decision that varies with the culture of each country you are visiting.
- Tipping may be done in US dollars or in local currency (Trinidad and Tobago dollars).
- You may want to plan a special budget for tipping expenses that you will distribute along the way in a special envelope with a thank-you note.



GENERAL TRAVEL INFORMATION

Below you will find information on important travel topics for your trip abroad. Should you have any additional questions not covered in the topics below, contact us by phone or email.

Safety and Security Abroad

Your safety is our paramount concern. To this end, we will always follow the recommendations of the US Department of State regarding overseas travel. We receive daily updates and rely on government guidelines to help us make decisions concerning the safety of our travelers.

For your personal safety, we encourage you to consider the following measures:

- Do not wear expensive-looking clothes or jewelry.
- Do not walk around alone; stay with your group or several friends, and stick to the main thoroughfares.
- Be aware of your purse or wallet and keep it in a safe place, especially in crowded or touristic areas.
- Keep your money in a safe place at all times (travel pouches worn under clothing are recommended).
- Keep important phone numbers with you, including the hotel details and emergency numbers.

Money Abroad

You can exchange money at the airport, hotel reception, or money exchange shops around the hotels.

International credit and debit cards such as Visa and Mastercard are accepted in most ATMs and in shops that accept card payments. With a foreign card, a small percentage of the amount withdrawn or paid will be charged; however, this amount remains quite low.

The best way to get money while abroad is with a debit card at a local ATM, because ATMs typically provide the best exchange rate. Call your bank before departure to alert them of the trip and confirm that your card will work abroad; foreign purchases sometimes result in a hold on bank accounts.

Keep your money in a safe place at all times.

Packing

The bottom line for any trip abroad: pack light! Keep in mind you will be toting your own luggage around at the airports and hotels, and we cannot guarantee the availability of an elevator. Make sure that you can climb at least one flight of stairs with your luggage and that it meets the airline's baggage weight requirement (you will be responsible for paying any overweight charges at the airport). Bring only what you need, ideally in one suitcase and one carry-on bag.

Clothing

Keep in mind where your trip takes you, and pack accordingly for the occasion. Comfortable walking shoes are a must. Pack shirts (short- and long-sleeved), socks and underwear, shorts, pants or jeans, pajamas and a bathing suit, fitting to your needs. Layer rather than pack for each type of weather or occasion. Bring clothing you do not mind getting paint or powder on for the carnival, and a light rain jacket for the rainforest.

Toiletries (travel size, 3 oz. containers)

- Toothbrush, toothpaste, shampoo and conditioner, soap, deodorant, sunscreen and insect repellent
- Hairbrush or comb
- Spare set of contact lenses or glasses (if applicable)

Documents

- Passport: bring a photocopy of it (in case it is lost) and leave one copy at home.
- A copy of the tour itinerary.
- A list of important phone numbers, emergency numbers and addresses to send postcards home.
- Copy of any prescriptions. Customs officials may want to verify that a container's contents match its label, so all medication should be carried in its original container.

Carry-on Bag

Here is a short list of things you might need on the first day of the trip. Pack them in your carry-on just in case your checked luggage is delayed.

- Passport, money and airline ticket
- Toothbrush and toothpaste (toothpaste must go in a one-quart zip-top bag and cannot be bigger than 3 oz.), hairbrush, contact lens case or glasses, and a change of clothes
- Medication
- Any valuables

TIME TO SAY GOODBYE



The Historic Moruga Spring Bridge, visited on Day 2 in Moruga

"Travel is fatal to prejudice,
bigotry and narrow-mindedness."

Mark Twain, *The Innocents Abroad*, 1869

Thank you for traveling with Celestial Voyagers.

YOUR NOTES